



The Network is partnering with researchers at Northwestern University to evaluate the Survivor Fund and understand how the program can best support survivors. This research is separate from Survivor Fund services. The researchers do not determine eligibility for the Survivor Fund, and your decision about research participation will not affect the services you receive from The Network.

What information may be shared?

- Information you enter into the eligibility form (name, date of birth, zip code, and whether you are eligible for the Survivor Fund).
- Whether you receive cash assistance from the Survivor Fund in 2026.

Why is this information needed?

Researchers will use limited identifying information (name and date of birth) to link your eligibility form to existing administrative records. Researchers may link to existing records measuring housing stability (e.g., eviction court records), use of services (e.g., shelter use), and broad measures related to justice-system contact (Chicago Police Department records). This helps the research team understand the impact of the Survivor Fund on participant well-being.

Important: The evaluation looks at group-level impacts, not individual cases. Results will be reported only in summary form (for example, percentages or averages). No individual information will be shared with The Network, and the research will **not** affect your eligibility for services.

How will your privacy be protected?

- All information will be handled under a formal data-sharing agreement and stored securely.
- Only a limited number of authorized researchers will have access to the data.
- Identifying information (such as name and date of birth) will be used only to link records across data sources and will not be used for analysis once linkage is complete.
- Findings will be reported only in summary (aggregate) form. The researchers will not share any individual information with The Network or include individual information in reports.

Will I personally benefit from participating in this research?

You may not benefit directly from participating. However, the information you provide will help researchers evaluate and improve the Survivor Fund, which could benefit future participants and guide similar programs that support survivors.



Northwestern University

Do I have to participate?

No. You can choose **not** to share your eligibility form information with the Northwestern research team by opting out.

Questions?

Principal Investigator: Elisa Jácome, Northwestern University (ejacome@northwestern.edu; 847-491-8200). This research has been reviewed by Northwestern University's Institutional Review Board (IRB). If you have questions about your rights as a research participant, you may contact the IRB at (312) 503-1376 or irbcompliance@northwestern.edu.